

55 Giving advice

The phrase "If I were you" is often used to give advice in English. By saying it, you imagine that you are in the same position as the person you are talking to.

-  **New language** "If I were you"
- Aa Vocabulary** Phrases for giving advice
-  **New skill** Making suggestions

55.1 KEY LANGUAGE "IF I WERE YOU"

English uses "if I were you" to give advice in second conditional sentences. The advice is expressed using "I would."

I don't know if I should take this job.



If I were you, I would take it.

English uses "were," not "was," in this context.

The advice comes after "I would."



55.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES "IF I WERE YOU"

I'm going to the concert tonight.



If I were you, I'd set off early. The traffic is awful.

I think I'll buy this shirt.



I wouldn't buy it if I were you. I don't like the pattern.

The suggestion can come first without changing the meaning.

There is no comma before "if."



55.3 REWRITE THE SENTENCES, REVERSING THE ORDER OF THE PHRASES

If I were you, I wouldn't leave my job.

I wouldn't leave my job if I were you.

1 I'd apply for a promotion if I were you.

2 If I were you, I'd invest some of my money.

3 I wouldn't buy that car if I were you.

4 If I were you, I'd take a long vacation.

5 I'd start my own company if I were you.

